

3) The derivative of a function $f = \sin x$ is zero at the points $x = \pm \pi n$ (at these points the tangent to the graph of the function is horizontal).

This "list" could, of course, be expanded.

Next I would like to attract your attention to the following: from the viewpoint of mathematics a derivative of a function must also be considered as a certain function.

Reader: But the derivative is a limit, and, consequently, a number!

Author: Let us clarify this. We have fixed a point $x = x_0$ and obtained for a function $f(x)$ at this point the number $\lim_{\Delta x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\Delta f(x_0)}{\Delta x}$. For each point x (from the domain of f) we have, in the general case, its own number $\lim_{\Delta x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\Delta f(x)}{\Delta x}$.

This gives a mapping of a certain set of numbers x onto a different set of numbers $\lim_{\Delta x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\Delta f(x)}{\Delta x}$. The function which represents this mapping of one numerical set onto another is said to be the derivative and is denoted by $f'(x)$.

Reader: I see. So far we have considered only one value of the function $f'(x)$, namely, its value at the point $x = x_0$.

Author: I would like to remind you that in the previous dialogue we analyzed $v(t)$ which was the derivative of $s(t)$. The graphs of the two functions (i.e., the function $s(t)$ and its derivative $v(t)$) were even compared in Fig. 35.

Reader: Now it is clear. remarks with regard to $f'(x)$.

Author: I would like to make two remarks with regard to $f'(x)$.

Note 1: A function $f'(x)$ is obtained only by using a function $f(x)$.

Indeed,
$$f'(x) = \lim_{\Delta x \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(x + \Delta x) - f(x)}{\Delta x} \quad (4)$$